TCS CORPORATE WEBSITE

Column Break Block — Developer Guide

Role / audience	Development — Developers, technical leads, block owners, AI coding agents
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Owner	Technical Lead / Block Owner (proposed)
Last validated	2026-11-08
Documents	1
Classification	INTERNAL — classification to be confirmed

Generated from the Markdown sources of docs/handover (branch migrated-page-content-edam); do not edit this PDF.

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Column Break Block — Developer Guide

Attribute	Value
Document ID	DEV-B-column-break
Audience	Developers, technical leads, block owners, AI coding agents
Purpose	How the Column Break block is built: files, model, structure, behaviour, variations, tests and limitations
Scope	blocks/column-break/ and its components column-break
Prerequisites	—
Owner	Technical Lead / Block Owner (proposed)
Approver	Product Owner (to be confirmed)
Version	1.0
Status	Draft for review
Last updated	8 November 2026
Last validated	2026-11-08 (model, files, imports from the code; reference pages from the live site)
Source files	blocks/column-break/README.md, blocks/column-break/_column-break.json, blocks/column-break/column-break.css, blocks/column-break/column-break.js
Related documents	Variations, Test coverage, Authoring guide
Related AEM paths	—

1. Summary

Attribute	Value
Block	Column Break
Folder	`blocks/column-break`
Type	Child item
Category	child-item
Status	Active
Purpose	Starts a column in a Columns Container or a Tab
Variations (summary)	Additional tab options of its column
Children	—
Code size	62 lines of JS and CSS

2. Overview

Business purpose. Lets authors say "a new column starts here" with the standard components, because Edge Delivery doesn't nest blocks in blocks: a column is a run of sibling components in a section.

User experience. Visitors don't see the Column Break; they see its column. Authors see a small label ("Contact details", or "Column 2") at the top of an outlined column in edit mode.

Templates / page types. Any page with a Columns Container or a Tabs Container. **Data source:** its own fields.

Related blocks. Columns Container (builds the columns), Tabs and Tab (Column Breaks in a tab; the Tab's Columns per row), Columns (the built-in block the Columns Container replaces).

When to use. At the start of every column of a Columns Container, and of every column in a tab.

When not to use. In a normal Section (it isn't offered there and would build no columns); to add space (use the Additional tab's spacing on the components).

Realistic use cases. "Contact details" and "Office map" columns of an offices band; "Image" and "Text" columns in a Cloud tab; hiding one column of a three-column row temporarily.

3. Source files

File	Link
`README.md`	GitHub
`_column-break.json`	GitHub
`column-break.css`	GitHub
`column-break.js`	GitHub

4. Components, models and filters

Component	Title	Resource type	Template name	Model	Children allowed
`column-break`	Column Break	`core/franklin/components/block/v1/block`	Column Break	`column-break`	—

5. Fields

The Additional tab fields (anchor, hide, padding, margin, animation) are common to the blocks and described in the content modeling guide.

5.1 Column Break (`column-break`)

Tab	Label	Property	Type	Required in model	Default	Options	Visibility
Content	Column name	`title`	text	No	—	—	—

"Required in model" is the model's `required` flag; whether a field is required in practice is stated in the authoring guide where it is known.

6. Dependencies

Import
`../../utils/placeholders.js`
`../../utils/properties.js`

7. For Developers

```
blocks/column-break/
├── README.md
```

```
├── _column-break.json
├── column-break.css
└── column-break.js
```

Decorator/Utility	Purpose	Execution or dependency point
utils/placeholders.js	getPlaceholders, loadPlaceholders, fillPlaceholder (UI text from the locale's placeholders, with English fallbacks)	column-break.js: { getPlaceholders }
utils/properties.js	readProperties, textOf, isOn, isOnByDefault (a toggle that defaults to on), optionOf, normalizeKey, textSource (key-value block properties)	column-break.js: { readProperties, textOf }

Responsibilities. `column-break.js` reads the name (`readColumn`, exported for `blocks/columns-container/columns-container.js`) and decorates the marker (label, `data-analytics="off"`). `column-break.css` hides `.column-break` and `.column-break-wrapper` and shows them with the label style under `html.adobe-ue-edit`.

Input DOM. A key-value block `div.column-break` with a `title` row; classes from the Additional tab (`anchor-…`, `hideblock`, `p*-N`, `m*-N`); the id from the Anchor ID (`decorators/block-options-decorator.js`).

Rendered DOM.

```
<div class="columns-container-column pt-400" id="anchor-contact">
  <div class="column-break-wrapper">
    <div class="column-break block anchor-contact pt-400" data-column-title="Contact details" data-
analytics="off">
      <p class="column-break-label">Contact details</p>
    </div>
  </div>
  <!-- the column's components -->
</div>
```

Decoration flow. The Columns Container is loaded before the Column Breaks of its section: it calls `readColumn` (the name is cached on `data-column-title`, so it can be read after the rows are gone), copies `hideblock` and spacing classes to the column and moves the id. Then the Column Break's own `decorate` replaces its rows with `p.column-break-label`: the name, else `columnLabel` with the column's index among the columns.

Exports. `readColumn(block)` → `{ title }`; `default decorate(block)`.

Parent contracts. Columns Container: a wrapper holding `:scope > .column-break` starts a column. Tabs: `columnsOf` checks for `:scope > .column-break` in a tab's wrappers and builds a `columns-container` block from the first one on.

Error handling. No name: the numbered label; no parent column: "Column 1".

8. Extending the Block

1. Add a field to `_column-break.json`, run `npm run build:json` and `npm run lint`.
2. A column option: use a `classes_*` field (delivered as a block class) and add its class to `COLUMN_OPTIONS` in `columns-container.js` so it is copied to the column; add its CSS scoped to `.columns-container-column`.
3. A value to read: add it to `readColumn` and cache it on a `data-column-*` attribute. Don't end field names in Text, Title, Type, Alt or MimeType; no sample values in the definition template.
4. Keep the template name "Column Break" (it is the block class; `test/models/block-names.test.mjs` checks template names against block folders).
5. Update this README and run `npm run build:docs`; `npm run build:modules` after changing imports.

9. Responsive Behavior

The Column Break's CSS has no media query: it is hidden on the page and shown as a label in edit mode at every width. Its column follows the Columns Container's responsive behavior.

Viewport	Layout	Image behavior	Interaction behavior
All widths	Hidden on the page; label at the top of its column in edit mode	None	Selectable in the editor

10. Accessibility

- On the page the Column Break and its wrapper are `display: none` (not announced); the label is shown only under `html.adobe-ue-edit`.
- The column keeps the content order at every width.
- A hidden column (Hide block) is removed from the page (`display: none`), not only visually hidden.
- The label text comes from the Column name or the placeholder `columnLabel`.

Author responsibilities: a logical order of the columns (also the order on mobile and for screen readers).

Developer responsibilities: keep the marker hidden outside edit mode and `data-analytics="off"`; keep the options on the column, not on the marker.

The Column Break handles no keys.

11. Data Layer and Analytics

- The Column Break is `data-analytics="off"`: not a component, no events.
- Its column isn't a component either; the blocks in it are components of the Columns Container (`parentId`).
- The path Adobe Client Data Layer → Adobe Data Collection (Tags) → AEP Web SDK → Edge Network → Analytics / CJA is the intended one, but Tags and the Web SDK aren't configured yet (blocked: measurement plan). No consent mechanism is implemented.

Trigger	Data-layer event	Required properties	Analytics behavior
Page load	None (excluded with `data-analytics="off"`)	—	Not measured

12. Performance Considerations

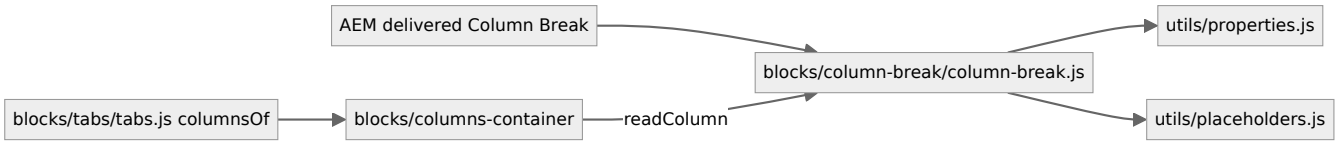
One placeholders lookup (cached), one small DOM replacement; no network, listeners or observers.

13. Security and Privacy

The label is set with `textContent`. No external content or personal data.

14. For Architects

- **Role:** a marker block that delimits columns among sibling components (no nested blocks in Edge Delivery).
- **Content model:** key-value block; its `classes_*` fields are delivered (it is a block, not a section).
- **Rendering:** read by the container before its own decoration; values cached in data attributes; the column is a plain element so editor updates of the components in it find their own block.
- **Data layer / Target / consent:** none. **Performance / security:** negligible.



15. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Diagnostic steps	Resolution	Verification
No columns	The Column Break is in a normal Section	Check the section class	Use a Columns Container	Columns appear
Label visible on the page	Edit mode (`html.adobe-ue-edit`) or CSS not loaded	Check the published page	—	Hidden on the page
Option changes not shown in the editor	Applied when the section is rendered again (R-C-7)	Reload	Reload	Applied
Content in the wrong column	Its position in the tree	Check the tree order	Move it after its Column Break	Correct column
Anchor link doesn't jump	Anchor ID taken (suffix `-2`) or mistyped	Inspect the column id	Use a unique ID	Link jumps

Evidence to collect: page URL, the column's classes and id, the Column Break's `data-column-title`.

16. Known limitations of the block

Limitation	Impact	Workaround	Planned correction
Option changes (Anchor ID, Hide block, spacing) apply after the section is rendered again (re-audit R-C-7, deferred)	No immediate feedback in the editor	Reload the editor	Not recorded
Columns have no own width	All columns of a row are equal	Use the container's Columns per row	Not planned
The `column` legacy rename is done only in Columns Container sections	Items named "Column" in tabs aren't Column Breaks	Replace them with Column Breaks	Not recorded

17. Change history of the block

Version	Change	Source	Date
Not recorded	README generated from verified implementation and approved handover documentation	Repository review	Not recorded
Handover 2.24	The Column item became Column Break (its template name is its block class); columns are plain wrappers with the Column Break as label; "Column" content still works (F-99)	docs/handover revision history	19 October 2026
Handover 2.28	Column Breaks in a Tabs Container tab lay its content out in columns	docs/handover revision history	20 October 2026

18. Reference pages

Kind	Page	Live URL
Curated design page	/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/industry-landing-page	https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/industry-landing-page
Curated design page	/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/services	https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/services
Curated design page	/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/story	https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/story
Curated design page	/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/what-we-do	https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/curated-design-pages/what-we-do

19. Coverage of the required topics

Topic	Where
Purpose	Overview
Source files	generated: Files
Model, definition, filters, children	generated: Components
Dependencies	generated: Dependencies
Authored input / rendered output / DOM transformation	For Developers
Configuration fields, defaults, required fields	generated: Fields
Variations	COLUMN-BREAK-VARIATIONS.md
Responsive behaviour	Responsive Behavior
Accessibility and keyboard	Accessibility
Analytics / data layer	Data Layer and Analytics
Performance	Performance Considerations
Security	Security and Privacy
Extending	Extending the Block
Known limitations	Known Limitations
Troubleshooting	Troubleshooting
Tests	COLUMN-BREAK-TEST-COVERAGE.md
SEO behaviour	Not recorded
Caching considerations	Not recorded (Edge Delivery default caching; no block-specific rule)
Ownership	Technical Lead / Block Owner (proposed)

20. Screenshots

> **Screenshot required**
>
> - Required screen: Column Break on its block library page
> - Required role/access: none (published page)
> - Required navigation steps: Open https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/column-break
> - Reason unavailable: No block library page of this block was found under /design-block-master/en/block-library
> - Owner: Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
> - Target completion date: To be confirmed

21. Known limitations

- Universal Editor dialogs were not captured: no author access in this program (see the access blockers).

22. Open items

- None.

23. Change history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	8 November 2026	Delivery team (documentation program)	First version of the role-specific documentation (master documentation prompt), generated from the repository and the published reference pages